# The Eye Witness

Written by

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INT. POLYPHEMUS'S CAVE - NIGHT

A vast, echoing cavern, lit only by a sputtering fire pit and the faint moonlight squeezing through the blocked entrance. The air is thick with the damp smell of sheep, fermenting cheese, and blood.

A massive, recently-moved BOULDER seals the cave opening.

SOUND: Low, agonized, non-human MOANS.

TELECLES, dressed in rough hide, stands over his older brother, POLYPHEMUS.

Polyphemus lies twitching on a sheepskin pile. His single, central eye socket is a horrific, blackened, oozing void. A rough, bloody bandage covers the wound, smelling faintly of herbs and burnt flesh.

Telecles slowly, carefully, removes the bandage.

The wound is not a ragged tear. It is a circular, deep cauterized burn, strangely neat for such savagery.

Telecles leans close, examining the work. He reaches a colossal hand out, gently tracing the perfect rim of the injury.

TELECLES
(A low, rumbling voice)
A knife could do this. A hammer could do this. But not with such… precision. They made a tool, brother. A stake. They sharpened it. They made it blazing hot.

Polyphemus lets out a shriek that rattles the stalactites.

POLYPHEMUS
NO-MAN! They were small and quick, like-like lice! They mocked the wine! They drugged me!

TELECLES
(Ignoring the outburst, focused on the wound)
They didn’t fear you. They didn't panic. Panic leaves ragged edges. This… this is craft. This is the work of a man with cleverness, Polyphemus.

Telecles drops the soiled bandage. He stands up. He looks at the ceiling, where a tiny sliver of moonlight.

TELECLES (cont'd)
When the others came, they heard the name, and they laughed. They said it was the gods. They said you were sick. But they were wrong. I will find the source. I will find the mind that birthed this trick.

Polyphemus, still thrashing, grabs at Telecles's leg.

POLYPHEMUS
(A choked whisper, utterly defeated)
I know it now! Before the ship escaped the rocks, he screamed it. He screamed his arrogance into the air. He told the sea!

Telecles freezes. He looks down at his brother, his single eye suddenly sharp and terrifyingly clear.

TELECLES
Give me the name, brother. Give me the source of our shame! Speak it now!

Polyphemus rolls his head as he sobs.

POLYPHEMUS
Odysseus! He spat it out in insult!

TELECLES
Odysseus?

POLYPHEMUS
Odysseus! Son of Laertes! The Sacker of Cities! He screamed it! He took my eye and then he gave me his name!

Telecles shoves his brother's hand away and strides to the cavern entrance, kicking aside a pile of sheep bones. He looks at the great BOULDER sealing them in.

TELECLES
(To himself)
Odysseus. Not a god-sent plague. Not a beast. A man. A clever man.

He runs his hand over the bounder. His rage simmering.

TELECLES (cont'd)
He dare mock you with xenia. He gave you the wine, not as a gift but as a ploy. He struck you, not with force, but with cunning. This is the work of a man with a mind, brother, and a mind can be followed.

He turns to face his brother. He slowly lifts finger to the wound.

TELECLES (cont'd)
I see not a raw hole, brother, I see a desire to hurt. The work of a man who lacks mural. HE cared not of the impact of his harm. They prepared for this, this stake. They planned it. They had time. They had the audacity of the weak! They know no honor!

He walks to the central fire pit, which has been scattered. He finds the remains of the stake: a piece of splintered, charred olive wood. He picks it up, weighing the insult in his hand.

TELECLES (cont'd)
He thought our revenge would mirror his. I'm sure he pictured a giant chasing a ship throwing stone.

Telesales snaps the charred stake over his knee.

TELECLES (cont'd)
(getting an idea)
Father. I will call upon Poseidon to claim the ship. But, I shall claim the man.

He moves to the entrance again. Places his hand upon the cool side of the BOULDER. He looks toward the distant sound of the sea.

TELECLES (cont'd)
He dare scream his name in outed arrogance. He wanted his story to be told.

POLYPHEMUS
(Whining)
They took the best of the rams! They stole the cheese! My sight! Brother! My sight!

TELECLES
The cheese, the rams, the eye. Brother these are just wounds, brother. The shame is what matters. The shame is the insult to our father, the god that he uses to make his escape, the god who is patron of this earth.

Telecles begins to roll the boulder.

He clears enough space for himself. Moonlight floods in, illumination the terrified pathetic face of Polyphemus.

TELECLES (cont'd)
Sleep. You may have taught him hospitality with muscle. But I shall teach revenge with patience and trust.

Telesales steps into the grass and doesn't look back.

EXT. CAVE ENTRANCE/ISLAND CLIFF - CONTINUOUS

Telesales strides to the cliff edge, the only one to hear the true name.

He scans the horizon, seeing on the black waves as far as the moon can assist. No ship.

He kneels, pressing his face to the rock and projects his voice to the waves.

TELECLES
Poseidon. Father. I wish for your rage to assist on the sea. As I will on the land. Once Odysseus reaches the home he longs for, I will be the shadow waiting at the door. He made you a new enemy. He made me a new purpose.

He rises.

He turns, walking down the path toward the other Cyclops caves.